

TOP 30 FINANCE FIRMS FOR INTERNSHIPS

The Complete Roadmap — Skills | Certifications | Networking | Resume Tips | Stipends

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This document gives you two things. First, a complete list of the top 30 finance firms in India where an internship will genuinely transform your career — even if it is unpaid. Second, a full roadmap covering the skills, certifications, networking strategies and resume tips you need to actually land one of these internships.

PART 1 — TOP 30 FIRMS WHERE YOU SHOULD INTERN

BROKING HOUSES

01 Motilal Oswal Financial Services [Top Pick]

Broking House

Rs. 10,000 - 25,000 / month

Resume Value: Extremely High

Why: One of India's most respected research-driven broking houses. Their equity research team is known for deep fundamental analysis. You will learn how professional research notes are written and how investment decisions are made.

Tip: Mention your CFA or NISM certifications in the subject line.

Apply: careers@motilaloswal.com | linkedin.com/company/motilal-oswal | internshala.com/internships/motilal-oswal

02 Kotak Securities

Broking House

Rs. 10,000 - 15,000 / month

Resume Value: Extremely High

Why: Part of the Kotak Mahindra Group — one of India's most respected financial conglomerates. Research and sales internships give exposure to institutional-grade equity analysis.

Tip: Address your email to the research head directly if possible.

Apply: kotaksecurities.com/careers | linkedin.com/company/kotak-securities

03 ICICI Securities

Broking House

Rs. 8,000 - 20,000 / month

Resume Value: Very High

Why: Large coverage universe covering Nifty 500 companies and beyond. Structured internship program with real research assignments.

Tip: Apply through website or reach out to research team members on LinkedIn.

Apply: icicisecurities.com/careers.aspx | internshala.com/internships/icici-securities

04 Edelweiss Securities

Broking House

Rs. 10,000 - 18,000 / month

Resume Value: High

Why: Known for quality institutional research and a strong investment banking arm. The learning culture here is genuinely good and analysts take mentoring seriously.

Tip: DM analysts on LinkedIn with your research sample attached.

Apply: careers@edelweissfin.com | linkedin.com/company/edelweiss-group

05 Axis Securities

Broking House

Rs. 8,000 - 15,000 / month

Resume Value: High

Why: Growing research team with focus on mid and small cap coverage. Less competition for internships compared to larger firms.

Tip: Contact the research team directly on LinkedIn.

Apply: axissecurities.in/careers | linkedin.com/company/axis-securities-ltd

06 Sharekhan*Broking House***Rs. 5,000 - 12,000 / month**

Resume Value: High

Why: One of India's oldest and most recognised retail broking brands. Good for learning the fundamentals of how equity markets work from a retail perspective.

Tip: Reach out to branch managers in your city for faster responses.

Apply: sharekhan.com/career-with-us | linkedin.com/company/sharekhan

07 Nirmal Bang*Broking House***Rs. 5,000 - 10,000 / month**

Resume Value: Medium-High

Why: Active research team with a focus on mid cap stocks. More accessible to students than larger firms. Good place to build your first real research experience.

Tip: Walk in to their nearest office with your research report.

Apply: careers@nirmalbang.com | linkedin.com/company/nirmal-bang

MUTUAL FUND HOUSES & AMCS

08 HDFC AMC [Gold Standard]*Mutual Fund House***Rs. 15,000 - 25,000 / month**

Resume Value: Exceptional

Why: Largest AMC in India by AUM. Internship here puts you inside how India's biggest fund house makes investment decisions — exposure to fund management, risk, compliance and research all at once.

Tip: LinkedIn outreach to analysts and fund managers works well here.

Apply: hdfcfund.com/about-us/careers | linkedin.com/company/hdfc-mutual-fund

09 SBI Mutual Fund*Mutual Fund House***Rs. 10,000 - 20,000 / month**

Resume Value: Extraordinary

Why: Largest AMC by AUM in India. Government-backed with unmatched credibility. See how institutional-scale fund management operates.

Tip: Apply through SBI Bank's campus recruitment channels too.

Apply: sbimf.com/en-us/careers | linkedin.com/company/sbi-funds-management

10 Nippon India Mutual Fund*Mutual Fund House***Rs. 10,000 - 18,000 / month**

Resume Value: Very High

Why: Strong equity research and fund management culture. One of the top five AMCs in India with exposure to equity, debt and hybrid fund management.

Tip: LinkedIn outreach to their investment team.

Apply: nipponindiamf.com/careers | linkedin.com/company/nippon-india-mutual-fund

11 Mirae Asset*Mutual Fund House***Rs. 12,000 - 20,000 / month**

Resume Value: Highly Respected

Why: Fast-growing AMC with a very strong equity research culture. Known for rigorous bottom-up research. The learning quality per hour is among the best in Indian asset management.

Tip: LinkedIn outreach to portfolio managers and analysts.

Apply: miraeassetmf.co.in/career | linkedin.com/company/mirae-asset-india

12 DSP Mutual Fund*Mutual Fund House***Rs. 10,000 - 18,000 / month**

Resume Value: Premium Boutique

Why: Boutique feel with institutional quality. One of India's oldest fund houses. Small team means more direct exposure to senior fund managers.

Tip: Smaller team means faster responses. Email HR directly.

Apply: dspim.com/about-dsp/careers | linkedin.com/company/dsp-investment-managers

13 WhiteOak Capital [Elite]*Boutique AMC***Rs. 15,000 - 25,000 / month**

Resume Value: Outstanding

Why: Founded by Prashant Khemka, former CIO of Goldman Sachs Asset Management India. Extremely rigorous research culture built around first principles thinking.

Tip: *Small team means decision makers are accessible. Always attach a research report.*

Apply: whiteoakcapital.com/careers | linkedin.com/company/whiteoak-capital

14 Marcellus Investment Managers [Elite]*Boutique AMC***Rs. 15,000 - 30,000 / month**

Resume Value: Elite Level

Why: Founded by Saurabh Mukherjee, one of India's most respected equity researchers. Known for extremely deep fundamental research on consistent compounders.

Tip: *Always attach a research sample. This is non-negotiable.*

Apply: marcellus.in/careers | linkedin.com/in/saurabh-mukherjee

EQUITY RESEARCH & INVESTMENT BANKS

15 Ambit Capital [Top Pick]*Equity Research Boutique***Rs. 15,000 - 25,000 / month**

Resume Value: Premium

Why: One of India's most respected independent research houses. Known for contrarian and high conviction research. Their research notes are read by institutional investors across the globe.

Tip: *Your research sample is critical here. No exceptions.*

Apply: ambitcapital.com/careers | linkedin.com/company/ambit-capital

16 Emkay Global*Equity Research Boutique***Rs. 10,000 - 18,000 / month**

Resume Value: Solid Institutional

Why: Strong institutional research team with good coverage of large and mid cap stocks. Well regarded among FIIs and domestic institutional investors.

Tip: *LinkedIn outreach to research team members.*

Apply: emkayglobal.com/career-with-us | linkedin.com/company/emkay-global

17 Prabhudas Lilladher*Equity Research Boutique***Rs. 8,000 - 15,000 / month**

Resume Value: Strong Institutional

Why: One of India's oldest and most respected research houses. Strong fundamental research culture.

Tip: *Email through plindia.com or LinkedIn outreach to their equity research team.*

Apply: plindia.com/careers | linkedin.com/company/prabhudas-lilladher

18 Anand Rathi*Full Service Financial Firm***Rs. 8,000 - 15,000 / month**

Resume Value: Well Recognised

Why: Large financial services group covering wealth management, investment banking and equity research. Good for exposure across multiple finance verticals simultaneously.

Tip: *Multiple teams to approach depending on your interest area.*

Apply: rathi.com/career.aspx | linkedin.com/company/anand-rathi

19 JM Financial*Investment Bank & Research***Rs. 12,000 - 20,000 / month**

Resume Value: Strong IB Credibility

Why: Strong investment banking and research presence. Good exposure to IB deal work, equity capital markets and research.

Tip: *Very useful if you are targeting investment banking roles.*

Apply: jmfl.com/career | linkedin.com/company/jm-financial

20 IIFL Securities

Full Service Broking

Rs. 8,000 - 15,000 / month

Resume Value: Strong & Recognised

Why: Large coverage universe with active research across large, mid and small caps. Structured internship program.

Tip: Apply through LinkedIn for fastest response.

Apply: iiflsecurities.com/about-us/career | linkedin.com/company/iifl-securities

21 Rare Enterprises [Legendary]

PMS Firm

Unpaid / Equity Exposure

Resume Value: Legendary

Why: Rakesh Jhunjhunwala's firm now managed by his team. One of the most iconic investment firms in Indian market history. The investment philosophy and culture built here is legendary.

Tip: Very small team. Prepare your absolute best research report before reaching out.

Apply: linkedin.com/company/rare-enterprises

PMS & BOUTIQUE INVESTMENT FIRMS

22 Stallion Asset [Elite]

PMS Firm

Rs. 10,000 - 20,000 / month

Resume Value: Highly Respected

Why: Young, aggressive and very high quality research culture. Founded by Amit Jeswani. Very active on social media and genuinely open to motivated students.

Tip: A good research report will get a response. Very approachable.

Apply: stallionasset.com | linkedin.com/in/amit-jeswani-cfa

23 Carnelian Asset Management

PMS Firm

Rs. 10,000 - 18,000 / month

Resume Value: Increasingly Well
Regarded

Why: Mid cap focused PMS with a strong fundamental research team. Founded by Vikas Khemani, former CEO of Edelweiss Securities.

Tip: Attach a mid cap research report for best results.

Apply: carnelianam.com | linkedin.com/in/vikas-khemani-b6a9a212

24 Basant Maheshwari Wealth Advisers

PMS Firm

Rs. 8,000 - 15,000 / month

Resume Value: Very Well Known

Why: Well known value investing firm. Basant Maheshwari is one of the most respected voices in Indian equity investing.

Tip: Research report on a consumer or retail company will resonate well here.

Apply: basantmaheshwari.com | linkedin.com/in/basant-maheshwari-3456963

25 Green Portfolio

PMS Firm

Rs. 5,000 - 12,000 / month

Resume Value: Growing Brand

Why: SEBI registered PMS that is very active on social media and genuinely approachable. Open to motivated finance students.

Tip: LinkedIn or Instagram outreach. Very approachable team.

Apply: greenportfolio.co.in/careers | linkedin.com/company/green-portfolio

26 Nuvama Wealth

Wealth Management

Rs. 12,000 - 20,000 / month

Resume Value: Premium Wealth Brand

Why: Formerly Edelweiss Wealth. One of India's largest and most respected wealth management firms. Exposure to ultra HNI client servicing, portfolio construction and investment advisory.

Tip: Very useful if you are targeting wealth management or family office roles.

Apply: nuvama.com/careers | linkedin.com/company/nuvama-wealth

27 Centrum Broking*Institutional Research***Rs. 8,000 - 15,000 / month**

Resume Value: Solid Institutional

Why: Mid size but highly respected institutional research house. Good coverage of mid and small caps.

Tip: Good for students who want research experience with more direct mentorship.

Apply: centrum.co.in/careers | linkedin.com/company/centrum-broking

28 Systematix Group*Research & Broking***Rs. 5,000 - 12,000 / month**

Resume Value: Niche Brand

Why: Active research team covering mid and small cap stocks in depth. Great for students who want to specialise in the mid and small cap space.

Tip: Email through website or LinkedIn. Good for mid/small cap niche specialisation.

Apply: systematixgroup.com/careers | linkedin.com/company/systematix-group

29 Kotak Mahindra AMC*Mutual Fund House***Rs. 12,000 - 20,000 / month**

Resume Value: Premium Brand

Why: Kotak AMC offers excellent institutional learning with strong fund management processes and premium positioning in the AMC space.

Tip: Apply through careers page or LinkedIn.

Apply: kotakmf.com/about-us/career | linkedin.com/company/kotak-mahindra-amc

30 Quantum AMC*Boutique AMC***Rs. 8,000 - 15,000 / month**

Resume Value: Boutique Prestige

Why: India's first direct plan mutual fund. Very strong investment philosophy built around value investing and low cost. Small team means high exposure to senior fund managers.

Tip: Very approachable given small team size. Direct email works best.

Apply: quantumamc.com/careers | linkedin.com/company/quantum-asset-management-company

PART 2 — THE COMPLETE ROADMAP

Skills You Must Build

Non-Negotiable Skills

- Financial statement analysis — reading and interpreting P&L, balance sheet and cash flow statements confidently
- Ratio analysis — profitability, liquidity, solvency, efficiency and valuation ratios
- Basic equity valuation — DCF, comparable company analysis and precedent transactions
- Excel — financial modelling, data organisation, charts and basic VBA
- Reading and analysing earnings call transcripts and annual reports
- Understanding of Indian capital markets — exchanges, regulators, intermediaries and instruments

Skills That Will Set You Apart

- Building a complete equity research report — investment thesis, risks, valuation and recommendation
- PowerPoint for research presentations and investment memos
- Bloomberg and Screener.in for data sourcing and stock screening
- Understanding of mutual fund structures, NAV, expense ratios and portfolio construction basics
- Knowledge of SEBI regulations relevant to research analysts and investment advisors
- Python basics for data analysis — not mandatory but increasingly valued

Certifications to Complete Before Reaching Out

Certification	Priority	Why It Matters	Register At
NISM Series XV — Research Analyst	DO FIRST	Mandatory to become a SEBI registered research analyst. Directly relevant to all 30 firms.	nism.ac.in
NISM Series VIII — Equity Derivatives	DO EARLY	Shows understanding of derivatives — relevant across broking, AMC and PMS roles.	nism.ac.in
NISM Series V-A — Mutual Fund Distributor	DO EARLY	Essential if targeting AMC roles. Very quick to clear.	nism.ac.in
CFA Level 1	HIGH PRIORITY	Gold standard globally. Signals serious commitment to finance.	cfainstitute.org
NSE Academy — Financial Modelling	DO ALONGSIDE	Free course. Directly teaches Excel skills these firms expect.	nseindia.com
NCFM — Investment Analysis & Portfolio Mgmt	USEFUL ADD-ON	Free from NSE. Adds depth especially for broking and research roles.	nseindia.com

Resume Building Tips

What to Include

- ✓ Keep it to one page only — no exceptions for students
- ✓ Lead with certifications and current studies prominently at the top
- ✓ Add a Projects section with equity research reports you have built independently
- ✓ Skills section: Excel, financial modelling, ratio analysis, Screener.in, Tijori Finance
- ✓ Add links to any research reports posted publicly (LinkedIn articles, Google Drive, Notion)
- ✓ Keep your objective statement specific — say exactly what role you want and why this firm

What to Avoid

- ✗ Do not add irrelevant school achievements unless finance-related
- ✗ Do not add a photograph — not standard for finance resumes in India
- ✗ Do not use fancy templates with too many colours or graphics — keep it clean and professional
- ✗ Do not write long paragraphs in your experience section — use short bullet points with numbers
- ✗ Do not apply without tailoring your objective statement to each firm

Networking and Reaching Out

LinkedIn Strategy

- Optimise your LinkedIn profile before reaching out — headline should say 'CFA Level X Candidate' or 'NISM Certified Finance Student'
- Connect with research analysts and fund managers at your target firms with a personalised connection note
- Comment thoughtfully on posts by analysts at your target firms before reaching out — builds familiarity
- Send a connection request first, wait for acceptance, then send your message — do not cold message without connecting
- Message template: introduce yourself in two lines, mention what you are studying, attach research report, ask for 10 minutes

Cold Email Strategy

- Always attach a research report to your first email — it is the single most important thing you can do to stand out
- Keep the email short — maximum 150 words in the body. Long emails do not get read
- Address the email to a specific person — find the research head or a senior analyst name
- Subject line: CFA Level X Candidate — Short Research Report on [Company Name] Attached
- Follow up once after 7 to 10 days if you hear nothing — a single polite follow-up is perfectly professional
- Never ask for money in the first email — position yourself as someone who wants to learn, not earn

Walk-In Strategy

- For boutique firms like Ambit, Stallion, Cernelian, Green Portfolio and smaller PMS firms, walking in is highly effective
- Print your research report and resume. Dress professionally. Go between 10am and 12pm
- Ask to meet someone from the research or investment team. If they are busy, leave your report with a handwritten note
- Follow up by email within 24 hours mentioning that you visited and left your report

How to Build Your Research Report Before Applying

Your research report is your entry ticket. Without one you are just another student asking for an internship. With one you are a student who has already done the work. This is the most important thing you can prepare before reaching out to any firm on this list.

What to Include in Your Report

- Company overview — what the business does, revenue model and key products or services
- Industry overview — market size, growth drivers, competitive landscape and key risks
- Financial summary — last 3 years revenue, PAT, EBITDA margins and return ratios
- Key ratios — P/E, P/B, EV/EBITDA, ROE, ROCE, Debt to Equity
- Investment thesis — 2 to 3 clear reasons why you are bullish or bearish
- Risks — what could go wrong with your thesis
- Valuation — a simple DCF or peer comparison with a target price

Free Sources to Build Your Report

Source	URL	What You Get
Screener.in	screener.in	Financial data, ratios and peer comparison for all listed Indian companies
Tijori Finance	tijorifinance.com	Deeper sectoral and company data
BSE India	bseindia.com	Annual reports, earnings call transcripts, regulatory filings

NSE India	nseindia.com	Shareholding patterns, bulk deals, insider trading disclosures
SEBI Website	sebi.gov.in	Regulatory filings and disclosures

Every single person on this list started exactly where you are. The difference between the ones who got in and the ones who did not was not their college name or their CGPA. It was the effort they put in before reaching out. Build the report.

Send the email. Walk into the office.

— @vanshkevichaar